

PLACEMENT EXPERIENCE – APPIAN

NAME: KISHORE A (2022115034)

ABOUT THE COMPANY:

Appian is a software company that automates business processes. The Appian AI-Powered Process Platform includes everything needed to design, automate, and optimize even the most complex processes, from start to finish. They have office locations all over the world, including Chennai in India.

CANDIDATE PROFILE:

The most important thing is the resume. It should be clear, concise, and well-structured. I ensured my resume was **one page** long, covering personal details, educational qualifications, projects (with short descriptions and technologies used), skills, co-curricular activities, and certifications/achievements (if any).

It is important to **only include content you are confident about**, as interviewers will ask detailed questions from it. Since the Product Engineer role emphasizes **data modeling**, I ensured I had strong preparation in DBMS, SQL, and related concepts.

PRELIMINARY ROUND – ONLINE TEST:

The first round was an **Online Assessment** held on the **Glider platform**. It consisted of **4 programming problems**:

1. 2D Vector Search:

- Given a 2D vector of strings and a keyword, search for the keyword in the vector.
- If found, return the **count** of occurrences and the corresponding strings.

2. Age Array Calculation:

- Given an array of ages, find the number of ages **less than 14** and **greater than 60**.
- Return `ceil(count) // 3`.

3. Maximum Rooms Booked Simultaneously:

- Based on booking data, find the **maximum number of rooms booked at the same time.**

4. Unattempted Problem:

- This was the only problem I left unsolved as I couldn't fully understand the requirements during the test.

I solved **three out of four problems** successfully.

TECHNICAL ROUND:

Mode: In-person (at CUIC)

Duration: 35 – 40 minutes

- I entered the room calmly with a smiling face, greeted the panel member, and handed over my resume.
- She began by asking about the **subjects studied till my last semester** related to IT.
- When I mentioned **Machine Learning**, she asked me to list the topics I had studied.
- She also asked how many problems I had solved in the online test and which one I didn't attempt, followed by my explanation of why.

Scenario-based Task:

- She gave me the scenario "**Stationery Management in our Campus**" and asked me to:
 - Draw an **ER Diagram** for the scenario.
 - Represent it in **table format**.
 - Perform **1NF** on one table.
- I explained my design and reasoning while drawing.

SQL Task:

- Query: "Select the total count of each item bought by the students."
- I wrote the SQL statement and explained the logic.

Conceptual Question:

- Difference between **XML** and **JSON**.

Coding Task:

- Scenario: “When an employee logs into the website, if today is their birthday, display a ‘Happy Birthday’ message.”
- I chose **Java Servlets** with **PostgreSQL** for the backend.
- Logic: Fetch DOB from employee DB, get current date from the system, and compare using **StringBuilder**. No frontend code was required.

Finally, she allowed me to ask questions, and I inquired about **support for freshers** when starting their journey at Appian.

BEHAVIORAL ROUND 1:

Mode: Virtual Interview

Duration: 10–15 minutes

- Introduced myself.
- Asked why I wanted the **Product Engineer** role.
 - I explained my interest in exploring this role after working on several software projects.
- Asked about the **role of PE at Appian**, which I described in detail.
- Stability check: Interviewer questioned if I was better suited for a Software Engineer role.
 - I confidently reaffirmed my interest in PE and declined the SE role.
- I asked about the **onboarding process**, and he explained it.

BEHAVIORAL ROUND 2:

Mode: In-person Interview

Duration: 5 minutes

- Asked about my **family details**.
- Asked about my **school details** – where I studied, **number of semesters**, and my **current CGPA**.
- Asked whether I truly wanted this role and to explain the **PE role**.
- I answered confidently, and the session ended shortly after.

PREPARATION STRATEGY:

- Focused heavily on **DBMS, SQL, and Data Modeling**.
- Revised the **projects** mentioned in my resume.
- Practiced coding on **LeetCode** and **GeeksforGeeks**.
- Prepared for **behavioral questions** and **role-based discussions**.
- Make a schedule on how you want to cover the topics and stick to it.
 - First: Arrays, Strings, Linked List, Graphs (BFS and DFS), Trees, Sort and Search.
 - Later: Dynamic Programming, Backtracking, Bit Manipulation.
- Towards the end, practice questions daily (LeetCode daily problem).
- For CP, I used: Striver A2Z DSA sheet
- For DBMS , i study SQL concepts in W3schools and watch you tube videos for normalization and refer basic DBMS concepts in GFG.
- For OS & OOPS , I studied in GFG

TIPS:

- Stay calm and composed. Do not get tense.
- Know everything that you've put in your resume.
- Have a good knowledge about DBMS, OOPS, and OS.
- Communicate clearly with the interviewer — explain your thought process (don't be silent).
- Prepare some standard questions for both HR and Technical round.
- When asked if you have questions for them, never say "no". Ask about projects, work culture, or role expectations.
- Read about the company before attending the interview.

Feel free to reach me if you need any help or have more questions at 7397585165.

ALL THE BEST!

